

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Professional Services Rate Card

Standard Hourly Rates & Pricing Policies

CONFIDENTIAL

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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1. Standard Hourly Rates by Level

The following table presents Meridian & Associates' standard hourly billing rates by professional level for the 2026 fiscal year. Rates are denominated in US Dollars (USD) and are applicable to all service lines unless otherwise specified in a client-specific engagement letter or master services agreement.

1.1 Onshore Rates (US-Based Professionals)

Professional Level	Standard Rate	Financial Svcs	Public Sector	Blended
Partner	\$750 - \$850/hr	\$800 - \$850/hr	\$650 - \$750/hr	\$800/hr
Managing Director	\$600 - \$700/hr	\$650 - \$700/hr	\$550 - \$625/hr	\$650/hr
Senior Manager	\$450 - \$525/hr	\$475 - \$525/hr	\$400 - \$475/hr	\$490/hr
Manager	\$350 - \$425/hr	\$375 - \$425/hr	\$325 - \$385/hr	\$390/hr
Senior Consultant	\$275 - \$350/hr	\$300 - \$350/hr	\$250 - \$310/hr	\$310/hr
Consultant	\$200 - \$275/hr	\$225 - \$275/hr	\$175 - \$240/hr	\$240/hr
Analyst	\$140 - \$200/hr	\$160 - \$200/hr	\$125 - \$175/hr	\$170/hr

1.2 Offshore Rates (India-Based Professionals)

Meridian maintains a Global Delivery Center (GDC) in Hyderabad, India, staffed with 850+ professionals across technology, analytics, tax compliance, and audit support. Offshore rates represent a 40-60% discount to onshore equivalents.

Professional Level	Offshore Rate	Discount vs Onshore	Blended
Senior Manager	\$220 - \$280/hr	48% - 53%	\$250/hr
Manager	\$165 - \$215/hr	49% - 53%	\$190/hr
Senior Consultant	\$120 - \$175/hr	50% - 57%	\$145/hr
Consultant	\$85 - \$135/hr	51% - 58%	\$110/hr
Analyst	\$60 - \$95/hr	53% - 57%	\$75/hr

1.3 Nearshore Rates (Latin America-Based Professionals)

Our nearshore delivery centers in Monterrey, Mexico and Bogota, Colombia provide time-zone-aligned support with a 25-35% discount to onshore rates. Nearshore professionals operate during US business hours and are fully bilingual (English/Spanish).

Professional Level	Offshore Rate	Discount vs Onshore	Blended
Senior Manager	\$310 - \$380/hr	26% - 31%	\$345/hr
Manager	\$250 - \$310/hr	27% - 29%	\$280/hr
Senior Consultant	\$195 - \$255/hr	27% - 29%	\$225/hr
Consultant	\$145 - \$200/hr	27% - 28%	\$175/hr

Analyst	\$100 - \$145/hr	28% - 29%	\$120/hr
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2. Volume Discount Schedule

Meridian offers volume-based discounts to clients with significant annual spend commitments. Discounts are applied retroactively upon reaching each tier threshold within the fiscal year (January 1 - December 31) and are calculated on aggregate fees across all Meridian service lines.

Annual Spend Threshold	Discount	Effective Blended Savings
\$1,000,000 - \$4,999,999	5%	~\$50K - \$250K savings
\$5,000,000 - \$9,999,999	10%	~\$500K - \$1M savings
\$10,000,000+	15%	~\$1.5M+ savings

3. Rate Escalation Policy

Standard hourly rates are subject to annual adjustment effective January 1 of each calendar year. Rate escalation is capped at 3.0% per annum for clients with active multi-year master services agreements (MSAs). For clients without an MSA, rate adjustments are communicated 90 days in advance and are based on market conditions, inflation indices, and competitive benchmarking.

- Annual escalation cap: 3.0% for MSA clients
- Non-MSA clients: rate adjustments communicated 90 days in advance
- No mid-engagement rate increases for fixed-scope statements of work
- Rate lock available for 24-month commitments exceeding \$5M annual spend

4. Alternative Fee Arrangements

Meridian offers flexible pricing models tailored to client needs and engagement characteristics. The following alternative fee arrangements are available upon request:

- **Fixed Fee:** Predetermined total engagement cost based on agreed scope. Recommended for well-defined deliverable-based engagements. Includes 10% contingency buffer.
- **Capped Fee:** Time and materials billing with a maximum fee ceiling. Provides budget certainty while maintaining flexibility for scope evolution. Cap set at 110-120% of estimated fees.
- **Risk/Reward:** Base fee at reduced rate (typically 70-80% of standard) with success bonus tied to measurable outcomes. Available for transformation and cost reduction engagements.
- **Retainer:** Monthly fixed fee for ongoing advisory access. Typically includes defined hours per month with rollover provisions. 10% discount vs. hourly equivalent.
- **Managed Services:** Fixed monthly fee for ongoing operational services (e.g., managed SOC, tax compliance). Priced per transaction/user/entity with SLA-based performance guarantees.

5. Travel & Expense Policy

Travel and out-of-pocket expenses are billed at actual cost with no markup, subject to the following policies and caps. All expenses must comply with Meridian's Travel & Expense Policy and are subject to client approval for individual expenses exceeding \$500.

- **Airfare:** Coach/economy class for flights under 5 hours; premium economy for flights 5-8 hours; business class for flights exceeding 8 hours. Booking required 14+ days in advance.
- **Lodging:** Actual cost, not to exceed GSA per diem rates (or local equivalent) for the engagement location. Extended stay negotiated rates apply for engagements exceeding 30 days.
- **Ground Transportation:** Actual cost for rental car, rideshare, or public transit. Mileage reimbursed at IRS standard rate (\$0.67/mile for 2026).
- **Meals:** Actual cost, not to exceed \$75 per day per person. Client entertainment meals require pre-approval for amounts exceeding \$150 per person.
- **Expense Cap:** Total T&E not to exceed 12% of professional fees unless pre-approved. Monthly expense reports provided with all supporting documentation.

For primarily remote engagements, Meridian offers a reduced T&E allocation with on-site presence limited to key milestones (kickoff, workshops, go-live, steering committee meetings). This typically reduces T&E to 3-5% of professional fees.

6. Large Enterprise & Transformation Engagements

The standard rate structures in Sections 1-4 are calibrated for mid-market engagements (\$500M - \$5B client revenue). Large enterprise and Fortune 500 / Global 2000 engagements involve additional complexity, regulatory scrutiny, geographic scope, and risk that are reflected in the following pricing adjustments and sample cost models.

6.1 Large Enterprise Rate Premiums

Engagements for Fortune 500 and Global 2000 clients are subject to a rate premium of 10-15% above standard rates, reflecting:

- Increased regulatory and compliance complexity (multi-jurisdictional, SEC Large Accelerated Filer requirements)
- Greater coordination overhead (multiple business units, geographies, time zones)
- Enhanced quality assurance requirements (mandatory EQR, concurrence partners, national office consultation)
- Senior staffing requirements (higher ratio of Manager+ level professionals)
- Dedicated account team infrastructure (relationship partner, account coordinator, innovation liaison)

6.2 Sample Large Enterprise Cost Models

The following cost estimates are illustrative for engagements typical of Fortune 500 / Global 2000 clients. All estimates assume standard rate structures with the 10-15% large enterprise premium applied, before volume discounts.

Engagement Type	Duration	Team Size	Fee Range
Large Integrated Audit (Fortune 500)	Annual	25-60	\$3M - \$8M/year
Enterprise-Wide Digital Transformation	24 months	80-150+	\$15M - \$40M
Post-Merger Integration (Multi-Year)	18-36 months	40-100	\$10M - \$35M
Enterprise Cloud Migration (1000+ Apps)	18-30 months	50-120	\$20M - \$50M

6.3 Multi-Year Engagement Discount Structure

Large enterprise clients frequently engage Meridian across multi-year programs. The following additional discounts are available for committed multi-year arrangements, applied on top of standard volume discounts:

Commitment Term	Additional Discount	Conditions
2-Year MSA	3%	Minimum \$2M annual spend commitment
3-Year MSA	5%	Minimum \$3M annual spend commitment
5-Year Strategic Partnership	8% (negotiable)	Minimum \$5M annual spend; joint innovation program

6.4 Dedicated Account Team Pricing Model

For clients with \$5M+ annual spend, Meridian provides a dedicated account team structure at no additional charge. The account team includes:

- Relationship Partner -- Senior partner with P&L accountability for the client relationship; monthly strategic reviews
- Account Director -- Full-time client-facing role coordinating across all active engagements and service lines

- Innovation Liaison -- Access to Meridian's R&D and emerging technology practice for quarterly innovation briefings
- Preferred staffing -- Priority access to top-rated professionals and specialists during peak periods

For clients with \$10M+ annual spend, the dedicated account team is supplemented with an on-site Account Coordinator (partially funded by Meridian) and annual strategic planning workshops with the Meridian executive leadership team.

7. Payment Terms

Standard payment terms are as follows:

- Invoicing: Semi-monthly (1st and 15th of each month) for time and materials; milestone-based for fixed fee
- Payment due: Net 30 days from invoice date
- Late payment: 1.5% monthly interest on overdue balances (waived for first occurrence)
- Retainer deposits: 10% of estimated engagement fees, credited against final invoice
- Electronic payment: ACH or wire transfer; credit card accepted with 2.5% processing surcharge